communities' (Sayeed 2018). Religious minorities have also been targeted repeatedly under the blasphemy laws. Accusations of blasphemy in Pakistan have proved lethal, where an estimated '62 men and women were killed on mere suspicion of blasphemy' in Pakistan between 1987 and 2016 (HRCP 2016, p. 96, citing the Centre for Social Justice). While laws related to 'offences' against religion date back to the British era, it was during the time of General Zia-ul-Haq in the 1980s that 'additional laws were introduced against blasphemy that were specific to Islam, including laws explicitly targeting the minority Ahmadiyya Muslim community' (Amnesty International 2016, p. 10). According to Amnesty International (2016) 'the most frequently invoked blasphemy laws in Pakistan's Penal Code' include section 295-A 'outraging religious feelings', 295-B 'desecrating the Quran', 295-C 'defiling the name' of the Prophet of Islam and 298-A 'defiling the names of the family of the Prophet' or 'his companion or any of the caliphs' (p. 10). Around '1,472 people … have been accused under the blasphemy laws between 1987 and 2016, specifically under sections 295-B, 295-C and 298' (HRCP 2016, p. 96). A blasphemous allegation against an individual in Pakistan is akin to a death sentence as evident in the case of Governor Salman Taseer who was assassinated by his security guard when he was accused of having committed blasphemy through his efforts to amend the existing blasphemy law, or in the case of 'Shama Masih and her husband Shahzad Masih' who were lynched by a mob when accused of blasphemy (Amnesty International 2016). Discrimination against religious minorities also exists in education and employment (UNDP 2016b[84]).

The issue of religious minorities was seldom raised by the participants in this study. It did not make the list of the most urgent issues facing Pakistan today. It was largely absent, with the exception of a few outliers who recognized the unfair position of religious minorities in Pakistan, including a member of the Hazara community: '*The basis for Pakistan was that security will be provided to minorities of all religions, as Muslims were a minority in the Indian subcontinent. But now it is the opposite*' (Academic, Male, Quetta). In a focus group in Lahore, when the students were asked about the meaning of Pakistan, the following discussion ensued:

A.: 'purity', 'haven for minorities'

Q.: Haven?

A.: 'That is what it was supposed to be. This is why it was made.' [Everyone agrees] 'The oppressed became the oppressors in Pakistan.'

(Focus Group, Private University[85])